



The Candler Foundry Sunday School Simplified, Kids' Edition

Ages: 2nd–5th Grade (questions adaptable for older/younger ages)

Gospel Text: John 20:19–31

Optional Use: Sunday after Easter

OPENING PRAYER

God, thank you for creating us and loving us. Please help us have fun and listen today as we learn about the story of Jesus. Help us to ask good questions and to see what the Bible has to say about our own lives. *Amen.*

WARM-UP & CONTEXT

1. What did we just celebrate at church? (Easter) What are we celebrating at Easter?

(Jesus rose from the dead. We call this “resurrection.”)

2. Does anyone remember how Jesus’s friends found out that he wasn’t dead?

(His friends went looking for him and he wasn’t in the tomb. Instead, he was alive.)

3. What do you think his friends felt? What would you feel if you were expecting something really bad to happen, but then something really good happened instead?

(Maybe surprised, excited, happy, scared, unsure...or even doubtful.)

Say to the group: Today, we’re going to hear a story about what happened next. Jesus had risen from the dead, but some of his friends hadn’t seen him yet. Let’s see what happens when he visits them.

SCRIPTURE READING

John 20:19–31 (The Message) – [LINK HERE](#)

(Read aloud to the group, or take turns reading.)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What are Jesus’s friends feeling at the beginning of the story? Why do you think they felt this way?

2. What did Jesus say to his friends when he enters the room where his friends are hiding? What does he want them to feel instead of afraid?
3. Was Thomas with the other disciples when Jesus first came into the room? Does he believe what his friends are telling him about Jesus being alive? Why not?
4. What does Thomas tell his friends he needs in order to believe?
5. Later, Jesus comes back to his friends again. This time, Thomas is in the room. What's the first thing Jesus does? Does he do what Thomas said he needed in order to believe?
6. What happens next – how does Thomas respond? Did Jesus help Thomas believe?

What does the story show us?

- Jesus helped Thomas by giving him exactly what he said he needed. It seems like Jesus was okay with Thomas's doubts, and helped Thomas grow in his faith.
- Jesus meets us where we are, even when we have trouble believing. It's OK to have questions. Sometimes, our questions show that we are trying our best to learn.
- We can't see or touch God, but that doesn't make God's love for us any less real.

OPTIONAL ACTIVITY

As a group, think of some things that make us feel comforted when we are feeling worried, afraid, or unsure. Examples: a hug from a parent, a teacher's encouragement, a friend's smile, a coach's high-five, or even a favorite book or song. Time permitting, each child can draw a picture depicting whatever gives them comfort.

Optional adaptation for older children: respond to the following prompt: "A time when I felt fear or doubt was _____. One thing that helped me was _____." Time permitting, invite one or two children to share their written responses.

CLOSING PRAYER

God, thank you for loving us, even when we don't understand everything. We know that you are with us, even when our eyes can't see you. Help us to trust you and to share your peace with others this week. *Amen.*

